FRANMARINE UNDERWATER SERVICES PTY LTD

ADVERSE WEATHER

Emergency Procedure

MV SEAGULL | UVI: 425689

Marine Order 504 (2024) — Schedule 1 Compliance

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Approval

Role	Name	Date
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Review Frequency

This document shall be reviewed at least every 12 months, or sooner following a significant incident, change of operations, vessel modification, or change in applicable legislation.

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1. PURPOSE

This procedure establishes the actions to be taken when MV Seagull encounters or is forecast to encounter adverse weather conditions.

1.1 Regulatory Reference

Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 12.

2. OPERATIONAL WEATHER LIMITS

MV Seagull is a 6.50 m open aluminium landing barge. The following operational weather parameters and limits apply to all operations from this vessel.

Parameter	Limit
Wind (sustained)	Do not depart if forecast ≥25 knots. Return to port if sustained ≥25 knots underway.
Gusts	Plan for 40% above forecast (forecast average winds × 1.4 = expected gust ceiling). Cease operations if gusts ≥35 knots.
Wave height	Do not depart if forecast significant wave height ≥2.5 m. Return to port if ≥2.5 m underway.
Swell	Consider combined sea state — steep short-period swell may require a lower threshold than the wave height limit alone.
Visibility	Do not operate if visibility <500 m. Reduce speed per COLREGs Rule 6 below 1 nm visibility.
BOM Strong Wind Warning	Proceed with caution. Master to reassess risk before departure. Consider not departing.
BOM Gale Warning	Do not depart under any circumstances. Return to port if already underway.
BOM Storm Warning	Vessel to be secured in port. No operations.

2.1 General Notes

- Squalls — avoid all squall conditions. Gusts can exceed 40–50 knots with minimal warning.
- Thunderstorms — cease all water-based operations. Remain clear of lightning exposure.
- Tropical cyclones — no vessel should be at sea within several hundred nautical miles of a tropical cyclone.
- Wave height planning rule — always plan for waves up to twice the forecast height. Individual rogue waves can significantly exceed the significant wave height figure.
- Gust planning rule — forecast average winds × 1.4 = expected gust ceiling. Use this figure when assessing whether to depart or continue operations.
- Master's authority — the master may cease operations at any time below these thresholds based on observed conditions, vessel behaviour, or crew safety.

3. WEATHER MONITORING

- Check the Bureau of Meteorology (BOM) marine forecast before departure and at regular intervals during operations.
- Monitor VHF Ch 16 for weather warnings.
- Use onboard instruments and visual observation to monitor changing conditions.

4. ACTIONS IN DETERIORATING WEATHER

- Reduce speed to suit conditions.
- Ensure all crew are wearing PFDs.
- Secure all loose equipment and close all hatches.
- If conditions exceed the operational limits, suspend operations and proceed to the nearest safe port or shelter.
- If unable to reach port safely, head into the wind and sea at minimum steerage way and ride out the conditions.
- Deploy the anchor in a sheltered position if conditions deteriorate further.
- Issue a PAN PAN on VHF Ch 16 if assistance is required.

5. FOG AND RESTRICTED VISIBILITY

- Reduce speed to a safe speed adapted to the conditions.
- Sound fog signals (one prolonged blast at intervals of not more than 2 minutes for a power-driven vessel making way).
- Post an additional lookout.
- Use radar and chart plotter.
- If conditions are too poor to navigate safely, anchor and wait for conditions to improve.

6. POST-INCIDENT

- Record weather-related decisions and actions in the vessel logbook.
- Report any damage or incidents to the East Coast Operations Superintendent.

7. REFERENCES

- FUS-SMS-SGL-06 Emergency Plan
- FUS-SMS-SGL-05F Navigation and Watchkeeping
- Bureau of Meteorology — www.bom.gov.au
- Marine Order 504 (2024), Schedule 1, Clause 12